

CHECKPOINT PLANNING

Marketing Material Submission for Compliance Review

New Marketing Material Compliance Review Package

Website (10 pages) and 3 new lead magnets

SUBMITTED BY

Date: September 21, 2026

Scott Marcoe, CRPC™ — Founder & Financial Planner, Checkpoint Planning

Checkpoint Planning — Capstone Financial Group | Ameritas Investment Company, LLC (AIC), Member FINRA/SIPC
Ameritas Advisory Services, LLC (AAS) | scott@checkpointplanning.com | (949) 702-0139

What's in This Package

This package contains every piece of new marketing material for the Checkpoint Planning lead-generation expansion, submitted together for a single compliance review pass.

1. Website — 10 pages

Home, About, Services, Our Process, Fees, and Contact (the general site), plus four dedicated landing pages for Job Loss & Layoff, Early Retirement, Divorce, and Inheritance & Unexpected Wealth. Each page below is captured exactly as it renders live, including the footer disclosures and Form CRS links.

2. Lead magnets — 4 guides

“Your Next Checkpoint” workbook (existing, previously produced) plus three new companion guides: Early Retirement, Divorce, and Inheritance — offered as opt-in downloads from the matching landing page.

3. Compliance notes

A summary of the required disclosures included throughout (fiduciary/FINRA-SIPC language, Form CRS links for AIC and AAS, fee transparency language, “not investment advice” disclaimers) for quick reference during review.

Planned Distribution

The website is planned to launch at a new subdomain (start.checkpointplanning.com) first, with checkpointplanning.com itself unchanged until this material is approved. Lead magnets are offered as gated downloads on their matching landing page; follow-up after a download is being handled manually by Scott for now, with the drafted email sequences held for a future automation build (not included in this submission). No paid advertising is planned until this package is approved.

CHECKPOINT PLANNING

Section 1

Website — 10 Pages (Live Render)



FINANCIAL CLARITY FOR LIFE'S IN-BETWEENS

A structured plan for the moment your life just changed.

Job loss. Divorce. Early retirement. Inheritance. When something major shifts, financial decisions get harder and more consequential. Checkpoint Planning brings a fiduciary advocate and a proven five-phase process to help you move forward with clarity, not guesswork.

- ✓ Fiduciary standard, always
- ✓ Fee-transparent, no long-term contracts
- ✓ Serving clients across the United States

Schedule Your Free Where We Begin Session

See how we help →

Where We Begin™ Session

A complimentary, no-obligation 45-minute conversation. No forms, no pressure — just clarity on your next step.

FULL NAME

EMAIL

PHONE

WHAT'S CHANGING FOR YOU?

Select one



ANYTHING YOU'D LIKE US TO KNOW? (OPTIONAL)

Request My Free Session

Your information is confidential and never sold. No obligation.

WHO WE SERVE

You are in the middle of something significant.

Most people know they need a plan. Few have one that actually keeps up with life. Here's where we focus.

JL

Job Loss & Layoff

Severance decisions, COBRA vs. marketplace coverage, unemployment, and a financial runway plan for what's next.

[Explore job loss planning →](#)

ER

Early Retirement

Retirement readiness, Social Security timing, pension elections, and building income that lasts longer than you planned for.

[Explore early retirement planning →](#)

DV

Divorce

Settlement analysis, QDROs, tax impact, and rebuilding a financial plan that's entirely your own.

[Explore divorce planning →](#)

IN

Inheritance & Unexpected Wealth

Thoughtful, unhurried decisions about a windfall — taxes, investing, and honoring what it represents.

[Explore inheritance planning →](#)

LS

Loss of a Spouse

Benefit claims, beneficiary transfers, and stabilizing finances during an emotionally difficult time.

CR

Career Reinvention

Sabbaticals, career pivots, and equity compensation decisions when you're building something new.

THE CHECKPOINT STRATEGY™

Your unique transition. Our systematic process.

A structured, five-phase planning process designed to bring clarity and confidence to life's most important financial transitions.

1

AWARENESS & DIRECTION

Where We Begin™

A complimentary 45-minute clarity session. No cost, no obligation.

2

SECURE THE ESSENTIALS

Identify & Protect™

Stabilize cash flow, review benefits and insurance, protect what matters most.

3

CREATE THE ROADMAP

Plot Checkpoints™

Build your plan with clear 30-, 90-, and 180-day milestones.

4

TAKE INTENTIONAL ACTION

Implement™

Execute the plan — rollovers, portfolio changes, documents, referrals.

5

ADAPT & MAINTAIN

Track & Reset™

Ongoing reviews and recalibration as your life evolves.

ABOUT YOUR PLANNER

Meet Scott Marcoe, CRPC™

Scott is a financial planner and CRPC™ professional who helps people find clarity and direction during major life and career transitions. As founder of Checkpoint Planning and creator of The Checkpoint Strategy, he brings structure and calm to moments that often feel chaotic.

His planning philosophy was forged on the race course. As a State Champion mountain bike racer and National Champion in 24-hour endurance racing, Scott learned that winning required breaking a massive challenge into manageable checkpoints and adjusting to real conditions along the way. Financial transitions work the same way.

"One checkpoint at a time."

Based in Orange County, California — serving clients across the United States, primarily via video conference and the Checkpoint Planning Client Portal.

CRPC™ — Chartered Retirement Planning Counselor

Registered through Ameritas Investment Company, LLC, Member FINRA/SIPC

Licensed Life & Health Agent

[Read Scott's full story and meet the extended planning team →](#)



OUR COMMITMENT

What you can always expect from Checkpoint Planning.

These are not aspirational statements. They are structural commitments built into how this practice operates.

- ✓ **Fiduciary Standard**
We are legally required to act in your best interest at all times — not the firm's, not a product manufacturer's, and not our own.
- ✓ **No Long-Term Contracts**
Planning engagements are flat-fee agreements. Investment management relationships can be terminated at any time.
- ✓ **Commission Disclosure**
Some insurance and annuity products carry commissions. When that's the case, it's disclosed to you in writing before any recommendation.
- ✓ **Full Fee Transparency**
Every fee is disclosed before work begins. Planning fees are flat. Investment management fees are AUM-based and billed monthly.
- ✓ **Direct Access to Your Planner**
You work directly with Scott in every meeting, every review, every planning conversation. Never handed off to a junior associate.
- ✓ **Coordinated Planning**
We work with your existing CPA, estate attorney, and other advisors so your decisions are never made in silos.

PLANNING PACKAGES

Transparent, flat-fee planning.

Pick the package that fits your situation. All planning packages include access to the Checkpoint Planning Client Portal. [See the full fee schedule →](#)

Clarity Session

\$1,200

- Investment management review
- Retirement account guidance
- Employee benefits review
- Cash flow management
- Insurance & beneficiary review
- One follow-up session

Full Picture

\$2,400

- Everything in Clarity Session, plus:
- Full financial plan (Client Portal)
- "What if" scenario projections
- Tax strategy coordination
- Social Security & Medicare review
- Quarterly reviews (year one)

Legacy Blueprint

\$4,800

- Everything in Full Picture, plus:
- Estate & trust planning review
- Wealth transfer scenarios
- Advanced tax planning
- CPA & attorney coordination
- Annual plan reviews, ongoing

FAQ

Questions we hear most often.

What does the first meeting look like?

The "Where We Begin" session is a 45-minute clarity conversation. We ask about your situation, your goals, and what feels most uncertain. No preparation needed.

How are you different from an advisor at a bank?

We are an independent, fee-based practice. We do not sell proprietary products, meet sales quotas, or earn commissions on managed assets. Our only financial incentive is the fee you pay us.

Do you only work with clients in California?

No. While we are based in Irvine, we serve clients across the United States. Most planning work is done via video conference and our online client portal.

What does investment management cost?

Fees are charged as a percentage of assets under management, billed monthly. Rates range from 0.65% to 1.25% depending on portfolio size, stepping down as assets grow.

Do I have to use your investment management service?

No. Planning and investment management are separate services. Some clients engage us for planning only. We discuss what makes sense in the Where We Begin session.

Who is a good fit for Checkpoint Planning?

Someone navigating a major life transition who needs a structured process and a fiduciary advocate. If that describes you, you are likely a strong fit.

[See more frequently asked questions →](#)

One checkpoint at a time.

The best next step is a conversation. The Where We Begin session is complimentary, carries no obligation, and takes 45 minutes. It is designed to give you clarity, not sell you something.

[Schedule Your Free Session](#)

CHECKPOINT PLANNING

3333 Michelson Drive
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LIFE TRANSITIONS

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EXPLORE

About Scott
Services
Our Process
Fees
Contact

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ABOUT YOUR PLANNER

Financial planner. CRPC™ professional. Endurance athlete.

Scott Marcoe helps people find clarity and confidence during major life and career transitions — job loss, career change, divorce, early retirement, and inheritance.

MEET SCOTT MARCOE, CRPC™

The planner behind the practice.

Scott Marcoe is a financial planner and CRPC™ professional who helps people find clarity and direction during major life and career transitions. As the founder of Checkpoint Planning and creator of The Checkpoint Strategy, he brings structure and calm to moments that often feel chaotic.

Scott's approach to planning is shaped by his background as a competitive endurance athlete. He is a State Champion mountain bike racer and a National Champion in 24-hour mountain bike racing. The long training hours, constantly changing terrain, and mental discipline required for endurance success influenced the philosophy behind The Checkpoint Strategy. Training to win meant having a clear goal, breaking the work into smaller checkpoints, and adjusting to real conditions along the way. Financial transitions follow the same pattern — progress happens through checkpoints, pacing, and smart decisions made under real circumstances.

Scott's planning process breaks big financial questions into clear, manageable steps so clients can stabilize quickly, build confidence, and move forward at a pace that feels right. His work is grounded in empathy, experience, and the belief that clarity creates confidence.

"One checkpoint at a time." That is the philosophy Scott learned from endurance racing, and the foundation of how he helps people navigate financial transitions.

Scott lives in Orange County, California and supports clients across the United States.



CREDENTIALS

Licensed, registered, and independently held accountable.

**FS****FINRA/SIPC**

Registered through Ameritas Investment

LH**Life & Health**

Licensed Life and Health Agent. Insurance

Planning Counselor

CRPC™
Chartered Retirement Planning Counselor,
College for Financial Planning.

Company, LLC, Member FINRA/SIPC.

License #0E59309.

Board Member, AISS (Achievement Institute for STEM Scholars) — Chairman, Marketing Committee.

COORDINATED SUPPORT

One point of contact. A coordinated team behind you.

You work directly with Scott in every meeting, every review, and every planning conversation — your relationship is never handed off to someone else. When your situation calls for specialized expertise, Scott coordinates that work on your behalf, covering areas such as:

TW

Trusts & Wills
Reviewing or establishing trusts and wills as part of your broader estate plan.

EP

Estate Planning
Legacy, gifting, and asset protection guidance when your plan involves wealth transfer.

CG

Charitable Giving
Structuring charitable contributions and giving strategies that align with your goals.

BE

Business Planning & Exit Strategy
Succession planning and the financial decisions that come with selling or transitioning a business.

TP

Tax Planning
Coordinating on income strategy, estimated payments, Roth conversions, and filing implications.

LI

Life Insurance
Coverage analysis and protection strategies tailored to your transition.

One checkpoint at a time.

The best next step is a conversation. The Where We Begin session is complimentary, carries no obligation, and takes 45 minutes.

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Home
Services
Our Process
Fees
Contact

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SERVICES

You are in the middle of something significant.

Most people know they need a plan. Few have one that actually keeps up with their life. Checkpoint Planning brings structure, clarity, and a fiduciary advocate to wherever you are.

LT

Life Transitions

Job loss, divorce, early retirement, inheritance. The moments when financial decisions are most consequential and most often made without a plan. This is where Checkpoint Planning was built to work.

IR

Investment & Retirement Planning

Building a portfolio aligned with your goals, timeline, and risk tolerance. Social Security timing, retirement income strategy, and ongoing investment management.

FP

Financial Planning & Organization

Cash flow, debt, insurance, estate documents, tax coordination. A comprehensive plan that connects every piece of your financial picture and keeps it current.

We also work with clients navigating inheritance and unexpected wealth, loss of a spouse, and career reinvention or sabbaticals.

LIFE TRANSITIONS WE SPECIALIZE IN

Dedicated planning for your specific situation.

JL

Job Loss & Layoff

Severance decisions, COBRA vs. marketplace coverage, unemployment, and a financial runway plan for what's next.

[Explore job loss planning →](#)

ER

Early Retirement

Retirement readiness, Social Security timing, pension elections, and building income that lasts longer than you planned for.

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windfall — taxes, investing, and honoring what it represents.

[Explore inheritance planning →](#)

stabilizing finances during an emotionally difficult time.

compensation decisions when you're building something new.

WHERE TO START

Starting the journey toward your goals.

We start by helping you prioritize what's most important to you today and in the future. Together we review the following areas of your financial life.

Life Transitions

- ☐ Recently moved or considering a relocation
- ☐ Job loss, layoff, or career change
- ☐ Getting married or divorced
- ☐ Recently retired or planning to retire
- ☐ Loss of a spouse or loved one
- ☐ Receiving a gift or inheritance
- ☐ Adding to family through birth or adoption

Tax Planning

- ☐ Income tax strategies
- ☐ Tax impact of severance or settlement
- ☐ Estimated quarterly tax payments
- ☐ Capital gain/loss strategies
- ☐ Roth conversion analysis
- ☐ Coordinating with my CPA

Investments and Retirement

- ☐ 401(k) or IRA rollover decision
- ☐ Retirement readiness projection
- ☐ Social Security timing strategy
- ☐ Pension election analysis
- ☐ Required minimum distributions
- ☐ Portfolio review and asset allocation
- ☐ Roth conversion and tax planning

Cash Flow and Debt

- ☐ Monthly budget feels unmanageable
- ☐ Building or rebuilding an emergency fund
- ☐ Debt payoff or reduction strategy
- ☐ Managing severance or lump-sum income
- ☐ Understanding my financial runway
- ☐ Planning for a major purchase or expense

Insurance and Risk Management

- ☐ Health coverage after leaving employer
- ☐ Reviewing life and disability income insurance
- ☐ Long-term care planning
- ☐ Reviewing beneficiary designations
- ☐ Umbrella or liability coverage
- ☐ Medicare planning

Estate and Legacy

- ☐ Reviewing or creating a will or trust
- ☐ Updating beneficiary designations
- ☐ Powers of attorney and healthcare directives
- ☐ Wealth transfer and gifting strategy
- ☐ Charitable giving planning
- ☐ Divorce financial planning (QDRO, settlement)
- ☐ Coordinating with an estate attorney

One checkpoint at a time.

Not sure where your situation fits? The Where We Begin session is the easiest way to find out — complimentary, no obligation, 45 minutes.

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Home
About
Our Process
Fees
Contact

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THE CHECKPOINT STRATEGY™

Your unique transition. Our systematic process.

A structured, five-phase planning process designed to bring clarity and confidence to life's most important financial transitions. Every engagement follows the same path.

1

AWARENESS & DIRECTION

Where We Begin™

Understand what is changing, define priorities, and establish a clear starting point.

2

SECURE THE ESSENTIALS

Identify & Protect™

Stabilize cash flow, review benefits and insurance, and protect what matters most.

3

CREATE THE ROADMAP

Plot Checkpoints™

Set 30-, 90-, and 180-day milestones with a plan built around your situation.

4

TAKE INTENTIONAL ACTION

Implement™

Execute the plan with focus, coordination, and support at every step.

5

ADAPT & MAINTAIN

Track & Reset™

Review progress, adjust as life evolves, and stay aligned with your goals.

The "Where We Begin" session is complimentary and carries no obligation. It is a 45-minute clarity conversation to understand where you are, what is changing, and whether working together makes sense.

WORKING TOGETHER

From your first call to your ongoing relationship.

Here's what a typical client engagement looks like from first contact through the first year. Every engagement is customized to your situation, but the structure remains consistent.

BEFORE DAY 1**Where We Begin Session**

A complimentary 45-minute clarity conversation. We discuss your situation, your goals, and whether Checkpoint Planning is the right fit. No cost, no obligation.

WEEK 1 TO 2**Engagement and Data Gathering**

You complete our financial intake and we gather the documents we need: account statements, tax returns, benefit summaries, estate documents, and anything else relevant.

WEEK 2 TO 4**Plan Development**

We build your personalized financial plan in the Checkpoint Planning Client Portal, including cash flow analysis,

retirement projections, scenario modeling, and a prioritized action list.

WEEK 4 TO 6

Plan Presentation

We walk through your plan together, explain every recommendation, and confirm your priorities. You leave with a clear 30-, 90-, and 180-day roadmap.

MONTH 2 TO 3

Implementation

We execute the plan. Account rollovers, portfolio construction, insurance applications, beneficiary updates, and referrals to attorneys or CPAs where needed.

ONGOING

Track and Reset

Regular check-ins and plan reviews keep you on track as life evolves. Frequency is based on your needs and your planning engagement.

OUR COMMITMENT

What you can always expect from Checkpoint Planning.

These are not aspirational statements. They are structural commitments built into how this practice operates.

- ✓ **Fiduciary Standard**
We are legally required to act in your best interest at all times — not the firm's interest, not a product manufacturer's, and not our own financial interest. Yours.
- ✓ **Commission Disclosure**
Some insurance and annuity products carry commissions. When that is the case, it is disclosed to you in writing before any recommendation is made.
- ✓ **Direct Access to Your Planner**
You work directly with Scott in every meeting, every review, and every planning conversation. Your relationship is never handed off to a junior associate.
- ✓ **Full Fee Transparency**
Every fee is disclosed before work begins. Planning fees are flat. Investment management fees are AUM-based and billed monthly. No hidden costs. No surprises.
- ✓ **No Long-Term Contracts**
Planning engagements are flat-fee agreements. Investment management relationships can be terminated at any time. We earn your business by delivering value, not by locking you in.
- ✓ **Coordinated Planning**
We work with your existing CPA, estate attorney, and other advisors so your financial decisions are never made in silos.

One checkpoint at a time.

The best next step is a conversation. The Where We Begin session is complimentary, carries no obligation, and takes 45 minutes.

[Schedule Your Free Session](#)

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EXPLORE

Home
About
Services
Fees
Contact

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FEE-BASED FINANCIAL PLANNING

Transparent, flat-fee planning.

We are committed to providing proactive, transparent financial planning to every client. Pick the package that best suits your needs and current situation. All planning packages include access to the Checkpoint Planning Client Portal.

Clarity Session

\$1,200

All services include:

- Investment Management Review
- Retirement Account Guidance
- Employee Benefits Review
- Cash Flow Management
- Goals and Priorities Review
- Insurance and Beneficiary Review
- Debt Reduction Planning
- One Follow-Up Session

Full Picture

\$2,400

All previous services, plus:

- Full Financial Plan (Client Portal)
- "What If" Scenario Projections
- Tax Strategy Coordination
- Held-Away Account Advice
- Multiple Goal Analysis
- Education Savings Planning
- Social Security and Medicare Review
- Quarterly Reviews (Year One)

Legacy Blueprint

\$4,800

All previous services, plus:

- Estate and Trust Planning Review
- Wealth Transfer Scenarios
- Stock Option Analysis
- Charitable Giving Strategies
- Advanced Tax Planning
- Roth Conversion Review
- CPA and Attorney Coordination
- Annual Plan Reviews (Ongoing)

All payments are processed via secure ACH. Ongoing planning and plan maintenance fees are discussed individually based on the scope of your engagement. We welcome any questions, at any time, regarding our pricing philosophy.

INVESTMENT MANAGEMENT FEE SCHEDULE

Straightforward, tiered pricing.

Checkpoint Planning directs and supervises the investment management of your assets, maintaining an appropriate portfolio allocation year after year. The rate is determined by your total portfolio value — whichever tier your portfolio falls into, that single rate applies to the entire account balance. No cost for the purchase and sale of securities within the managed account.

ASSETS UNDER MANAGEMENT	CHECKPOINT PLANNING FEE	INDUSTRY AVERAGE FEE*
Up to \$250,000	1.25%	1.26%
\$250,001 to \$1,000,000	1.00%	1.05%

\$1,000,001 to \$2,000,000	0.85%	0.91%
\$2,000,001 to \$3,000,000	0.75%	0.76%
Above \$3,000,000	0.65%	0.66%

*Industry average fees based on Cerulli, US Advisor Metrics 2023.

The fee schedule includes:

- Investment Management Account billing, Portfolio Performance Reporting, and Consolidated Online Account Access
- Record keeping of original cost basis
- Custom Analysis of Investment Risk Tolerance
- Asset Allocation and Portfolio Management Review

A note on strategy

We aim to address a variety of complex financial situations with plans and solutions tailored to meet your specific needs. In order to do this, we utilize a variety of investment strategies and methods. Please note that additional corresponding platform or investment strategist fees may be applied to the Advisor Fee and will vary depending on the specific platform or strategist.

Questions about pricing?

We welcome them, at any time. The Where We Begin session is a great place to start — complimentary and no obligation.

Schedule Your Free Session

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LET'S TALK

One checkpoint at a time.

The best next step is a conversation. The Where We Begin session is complimentary, carries no obligation, and takes 45 minutes. It is designed to give you clarity, not sell you something.

✓ You talk, we listen ✓ We ask the right questions ✓ We're honest about fit

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Where We Begin™ Session

A complimentary, no-obligation 45-minute conversation. No forms, no pressure — just clarity on your next step.

FULL NAME

EMAIL

PHONE

WHAT'S CHANGING FOR YOU?

Select one



ANYTHING YOU'D LIKE US TO KNOW? (OPTIONAL)

[Request My Free Session](#)

Your information is confidential and never sold. No obligation.

WHAT TO EXPECT

In your Where We Begin session:

1

You talk, we listen.

Tell us where you are, what just happened, and what feels most uncertain. No agenda, no forms.

2

We ask the right questions.

We help you see the financial decisions in front of you clearly, including ones you may not have considered.

3

We are honest about fit.

If Checkpoint Planning is the right choice for you, we explain how. If it is not, we tell you that too.

[FAQ](#)

Questions we hear most often.

What does the first meeting look like?

The "Where We Begin" session is a 45-minute clarity conversation. We ask about your situation, your goals, and what feels most uncertain. No preparation needed.

How are you different from an advisor at a bank?

We are an independent, fee-based practice. We do not sell proprietary products, meet sales quotas, or earn commissions on managed assets. Our only financial incentive is the fee you pay us.

Do you only work with clients in California?

No. While we are based in Irvine, we serve clients across the United States. Most planning work is done via video conference and our online client portal.

What does investment management cost?

Fees are charged as a percentage of assets under management, billed monthly. Rates range from 0.65% to 1.25% depending on portfolio size, stepping down as assets grow. See the full [fee schedule](#).

How long does the planning process take?

The initial engagement typically runs four to six weeks from intake to plan presentation. Implementation follows and can take an additional two to four weeks.

Do I have to use your investment management service?

No. Planning and investment management are separate services. Some clients engage us for planning only. We discuss what makes sense in the Where We Begin session.

Who is a good fit for Checkpoint Planning?

Someone navigating a major life transition who needs a structured process and a fiduciary advocate. If that describes you, you are likely a strong fit.

What happens after the plan is delivered?

Implementation, then ongoing support. We execute the plan together, then review it regularly through the Track and Reset phase.

VISIT OR CALL

Based in Irvine, serving clients nationwide.

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LIFE TRANSITIONS

Job Loss & Layoff

Early Retirement

Divorce

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EXPLORE

Home

About

Services

Our Process

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Form CRS ▼

(949) 702-0139

Get My Free Workbook

JOB LOSS & LAYOFF PLANNING

Just lost your job? Get a clear 90-day plan before you make any big decisions.

Severance, COBRA, unemployment, your 401(k) — a layoff puts a dozen financial decisions in front of you at once, usually the week you can least afford to rush them. Checkpoint Planning helps you slow down, stabilize, and know what to do first.

- ✓ Free "Your Next Checkpoint" workbook
- ✓ No cost, no obligation clarity session
- ✓ Fiduciary advocate, not a product salesperson

Download the Free Workbook

How we help →

Get Your Free Workbook

"Your Next Checkpoint" — a 90-day workbook to organize your income, expenses, runway, and priorities after a layoff. Plus an invitation to a free Where We Begin session.

FULL NAME

EMAIL

PHONE (OPTIONAL)

WHAT JUST HAPPENED, IN A SENTENCE? (OPTIONAL)

e.g. Laid off two weeks ago, unsure about my 401(k) and COBRA.

Send Me the Workbook

Your information is confidential and never sold. No obligation.

WHAT A LAYOFF ACTUALLY PUTS ON YOUR PLATE

You don't need to figure this out alone — or all at once.

These are the decisions that show up in the first 30 days. Most don't need to be solved today.

1

Severance & Unemployment

Understanding severance structure, tax withholding, and whether — and when — to file for unemployment.

2

Health Coverage

COBRA vs. marketplace vs. a spouse's plan — comparing real costs and deadlines before coverage lapses.

3

Your 401(k)

Rollover, leave it, or something else — a decision that's easy to get wrong under time pressure.

4

Your Financial Runway

How long your savings and severance

5

Spending & Debt Priorities

What to keep, reduce, or pause — and which

6

What Can Wait

Not every decision needs to happen this

actually cover essential expenses, so you know your real timeline.

debts genuinely need to stay current right now.

month. Knowing what to defer reduces stress and prevents mistakes.

FREE RESOURCE

Your Next Checkpoint: Financial Clarity During Career Transition

A companion workbook for navigating job loss, career change, or employment transitions. Organize your income, expenses, runway, and a 30/60/90-day plan — at your own pace.

Get the Free Workbook

THE CHECKPOINT STRATEGY™

A structured process for an unstructured moment.

1 AWARENESS & DIRECTION Where We Begin™ Free 45-minute clarity session. No cost, no obligation.	2 SECURE THE ESSENTIALS Identify & Protect™ Stabilize cash flow, benefits, and insurance gaps.	3 CREATE THE ROADMAP Plot Checkpoints™ 30-, 90-, and 180-day milestones built around your runway.	4 TAKE INTENTIONAL ACTION Implement™ Rollovers, benefits decisions, and next steps — executed.	5 ADAPT & MAINTAIN Track & Reset™ Ongoing support as your next chapter takes shape.
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ABOUT YOUR PLANNER

Meet Scott Marcoe, CRPC™

Scott helps people find clarity and direction during major life and career transitions, including job loss and layoffs. As a fiduciary, he is legally required to act in your best interest — not to sell you a product.

"One checkpoint at a time."

Based in Orange County, California — serving clients across the United States via video conference and the Checkpoint Planning Client Portal.

FAQ

Questions people ask after a layoff.

I just got laid off. What should I do first?

Start with the free workbook — it walks through severance, benefits deadlines, and your financial runway. Then schedule a free Where We Begin session to talk through your specific situation.

Does the free session cost anything?

No. The Where We Begin session is a complimentary, 45-minute clarity conversation with no obligation.

Do you help with severance and 401(k) decisions specifically?

Yes — this is core to what we do. We help you understand severance tax treatment, COBRA vs. marketplace options, and whether to roll over, leave, or otherwise handle your 401(k).

What if I haven't found a new job yet?

That's exactly who this is for. We help you build a plan around uncertainty, not around a guaranteed next paycheck.

One checkpoint at a time.

Get the free workbook, then schedule your complimentary Where We Begin session whenever you're ready to talk it through.

[Get My Free Workbook](#)

CHECKPOINT PLANNING

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Irvine, CA 92612

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LIFE TRANSITIONS

Job Loss & Layoff
Early Retirement
Divorce
Inheritance

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Scott Marcoe offers products and services using the following business names: Checkpoint Planning — Capstone Financial Group, insurance and financial services | Ameritas Investment Company, LLC (AIC), Member FINRA/SIPC, securities and investments | Ameritas Advisory Services, LLC (AAS), investment advisory services. AIC and AAS are not affiliated with Capstone Financial Group. For educational purposes only. Not investment advice.

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Get My Free Guide

EARLY RETIREMENT PLANNING

Retiring earlier than planned? Make sure your money can retire too.

Whether it's your choice or the decision was made for you, early retirement changes the math — on Social Security timing, healthcare before Medicare, pension elections, and how long your portfolio needs to last. Checkpoint Planning helps you pressure-test the plan before you commit.

- ✓ Free Early Retirement Checkpoint Guide
- ✓ No cost, no obligation clarity session
- ✓ Fiduciary advocate, not a product salesperson

Download the Free Guide

How we help →

Get Your Free Guide

The Early Retirement Checkpoint Guide — key decisions on income, healthcare, and timing before you retire. Plus an invitation to a free Where We Begin session.

FULL NAME

EMAIL

PHONE (OPTIONAL)

WHAT'S YOUR TIMELINE? (OPTIONAL)

e.g. Considering retiring in the next 12-18 months, before 65.

Send Me the Guide

Your information is confidential and never sold. No obligation.

WHAT EARLY RETIREMENT CHANGES

The decisions that don't wait until 65.

Retiring before traditional retirement age means solving problems the standard playbook doesn't cover.

1

Healthcare Before Medicare

COBRA, marketplace coverage, or a spouse's plan — bridging the gap until Medicare eligibility at 65.

2

Social Security Timing

When to claim — and how retiring early changes the tradeoffs between claiming early, at full retirement age, or later.

3

Pension Elections

Lump sum vs. annuity, survivor benefit options — decisions that are usually permanent once made.

4

Portfolio Longevity

A "what if" retirement readiness projection that accounts for a longer retirement than you

5

Required Minimum Distributions

Sequencing withdrawals and Roth conversions in the years before RMDs begin.

6

401(k) & IRA Rollover Decisions

Whether to consolidate, roll over, or leave accounts where they are — and the tax

originally planned for.

impact of each choice.

FREE RESOURCE

The Early Retirement Checkpoint Guide

A short, practical guide to the healthcare, Social Security, pension, and portfolio decisions that come with retiring earlier than the standard timeline.

Get the Free Guide

THE CHECKPOINT STRATEGY™

A structured process for a permanent decision.

1	2	3	4	5
AWARENESS & DIRECTION	SECURE THE ESSENTIALS	CREATE THE ROADMAP	TAKE INTENTIONAL ACTION	ADAPT & MAINTAIN
Where We Begin™	Identify & Protect™	Plot Checkpoints™	Implement™	Track & Reset™
Free 45-minute clarity session. No cost, no obligation.	Stabilize health coverage, benefits, and income sources.	Retirement income projections and 30-, 90-, 180-day milestones.	Pension elections, Social Security filing, portfolio restructuring.	Annual reviews as markets and your life evolve.



ABOUT YOUR PLANNER

Meet Scott Marcoe, CRPC™

Scott is a CRPC™ — Chartered Retirement Planning Counselor — who specializes in helping people navigate the financial decisions of early retirement. As a fiduciary, he's legally required to act in your best interest.

"One checkpoint at a time."

Based in Orange County, California — serving clients across the United States via video conference and the Checkpoint Planning Client Portal.

FAQ

Questions people ask about early retirement.

Is it too early to plan if I haven't set a retirement date yet?

No — the earlier we run the numbers, the more options you have. The free guide and a Where We Begin session can help you pressure-test a timeline before you commit to it.

Can you help with Social Security timing specifically?

Yes. Social Security timing strategy is part of every retirement engagement, alongside pension elections and RMD planning.

What if my retirement wasn't entirely voluntary?

Many clients arrive here after a layoff or buyout accelerated a retirement they hadn't fully planned for. We build the plan around your real timeline, not the one you expected.

Do you help figure out health coverage before Medicare?

Yes — comparing COBRA, marketplace plans, and other options is part of the Identify & Protect phase.

One checkpoint at a time.

Get the free guide, then schedule your complimentary Where We Begin session whenever you're ready to talk it through.

[Get My Free Guide](#)

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Get My Free Guide

DIVORCE FINANCIAL PLANNING

Divorce changes everything financially. Build a plan that's entirely your own.

Settlement analysis, QDROs, tax filing status, splitting retirement accounts, and rebuilding a budget on your own — divorce brings a wave of financial decisions on top of an already difficult time. Checkpoint Planning helps you see the full picture clearly, and independently of the emotion of the moment.

- ✓ Free Divorce Financial Checkpoint Guide
- ✓ No cost, no obligation clarity session
- ✓ Confidential, fiduciary advocate

Download the Free Guide

How we help →

Get Your Free Guide

The Divorce Financial Checkpoint Guide — what to understand before you sign a settlement. Plus an invitation to a free, confidential Where We Begin session.

FULL NAME

EMAIL

PHONE (OPTIONAL)

WHERE ARE YOU IN THE PROCESS? (OPTIONAL)

e.g. In mediation, reviewing a proposed settlement.

Send Me the Guide

Every conversation is confidential. Your information is never sold. No obligation.

WHAT DIVORCE PUTS ON THE TABLE

The financial decisions behind the legal ones.

Your attorney handles the legal process. Checkpoint Planning helps you understand what the numbers actually mean for your life afterward.

1

Settlement Analysis

Understanding the real, after-tax value of a proposed settlement — not just the headline number.

2

QDROs & Retirement Accounts

How 401(k)s, pensions, and IRAs are divided, and the tax rules that apply to each.

3

Tax Impact

Filing status changes, support payment tax treatment, and capital gains on any assets that are sold or transferred.

4

5

6

A New Household Budget

Rebuilding a realistic cash flow plan for a single household, often on a single income.

Insurance & Beneficiaries

Updating life insurance, health coverage, and beneficiary designations that often get missed after a divorce is final.

Coordinating With Your Attorney

Working alongside your divorce attorney so financial and legal decisions are aligned, not made in isolation.

FREE RESOURCE

The Divorce Financial Checkpoint Guide

A clear-eyed guide to the financial questions worth asking before you finalize a settlement — and the ones to revisit in the year after.

[Get the Free Guide](#)

THE CHECKPOINT STRATEGY™

A steady process for an unsteady time.

1 AWARENESS & DIRECTION Where We Begin™ Free, confidential 45-minute clarity session.	2 SECURE THE ESSENTIALS Identify & Protect™ Stabilize cash flow, insurance, and beneficiary designations.	3 CREATE THE ROADMAP Plot Checkpoints™ A plan built around your settlement and new household budget.	4 TAKE INTENTIONAL ACTION Implement™ QDRO execution, account splits, and document updates.	5 ADAPT & MAINTAIN Track & Reset™ Ongoing reviews as your new chapter takes shape.
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ABOUT YOUR PLANNER

Meet Scott Marcoe, CRPC™

Scott helps people rebuild a clear, independent financial plan during and after divorce. As a fiduciary, he works only for you — never for an attorney, a bank, or a product manufacturer.

"One checkpoint at a time."

Based in Orange County, California — serving clients across the United States via video conference and the Checkpoint Planning Client Portal.

FAQ

Questions people ask during divorce.

Is this a replacement for my divorce attorney?

No. We work alongside your attorney, focused on the financial implications of your settlement — not the legal process itself.

Can you review a settlement before I sign it?

Yes. Understanding the real financial impact of a proposed settlement is one of the most common reasons clients reach out before finalizing.

Is our conversation confidential?

Yes. Everything discussed in a Where We Begin session and any engagement afterward is confidential.

What if I've never managed the finances before?

That's a common starting point. We build the plan from the ground up, in plain language, at a pace that works for you.

One checkpoint at a time.

Get the free guide, then schedule your complimentary, confidential
Where We Begin session whenever you're ready.

[Get My Free Guide](#)

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Get My Free Guide

INHERITANCE & UNEXPECTED WEALTH

Received an inheritance? Slow down before you decide anything.

An inheritance brings relief, grief, opportunity, and pressure all at once — plus real decisions about taxes, investing, and what the money represents. There is rarely a need to decide anything quickly. Checkpoint Planning helps you take the time to get it right.

- ✓ Free Inheritance Checkpoint Guide
- ✓ No cost, no obligation clarity session
- ✓ Thoughtful, unhurried, fiduciary guidance

Download the Free Guide

How we help →

Get Your Free Guide

The Inheritance Checkpoint Guide — first steps, tax basics, and questions to ask before you invest or spend. Plus an invitation to a free Where We Begin session.

FULL NAME

EMAIL

PHONE (OPTIONAL)

WHAT WOULD BE MOST HELPFUL TO TALK THROUGH?
(OPTIONAL)

e.g. Inherited an IRA and a house, not sure what to do with either.

Send Me the Guide

Your information is confidential and never sold. No obligation.

WHAT AN INHERITANCE PUTS IN FRONT OF YOU

Decisions worth making carefully, not quickly.

Most inheritance mistakes come from moving too fast. Here's what's actually worth thinking through.

1

Inherited IRA Rules

Required distribution timelines and tax treatment differ significantly depending on your relationship to the deceased.

2

Tax Basics

Understanding step-up in cost basis, potential capital gains, and estate versus income tax exposure.

3

Real Estate & Property

Keep, rent, or sell — weighing the financial and emotional considerations of an inherited home.

4

Investing the Proceeds

5

Debt & Goals

6

What It Represents

Building a portfolio and asset allocation that fits your goals and risk tolerance, not just what was inherited.

Deciding whether to pay down debt, fund goals, or invest — often all three, in the right proportion.

Space to think through what this money means to you, and how you want to honor it, before deciding what to do with it.

FREE RESOURCE

The Inheritance Checkpoint Guide

A calm, practical first look at inherited IRA rules, tax basics, and the questions worth asking before you invest, spend, or sell.

Get the Free Guide

THE CHECKPOINT STRATEGY™

No need to decide everything at once.

1 AWARENESS & DIRECTION Where We Begin™ Free 45-minute clarity session. No cost, no obligation.	2 SECURE THE ESSENTIALS Identify & Protect™ Understand tax deadlines and protect the assets while you decide.	3 CREATE THE ROADMAP Plot Checkpoints™ A plan for investing, spending, and goals — on your timeline.	4 TAKE INTENTIONAL ACTION Implement™ Account transfers, investment allocation, and document updates.	5 ADAPT & MAINTAIN Track & Reset™ Ongoing reviews as the plan and your goals evolve.
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ABOUT YOUR PLANNER

Meet Scott Marcoe, CRPC™

Scott helps people navigate inheritance and unexpected wealth thoughtfully — with no pressure to decide quickly. As a fiduciary, he's legally required to act in your best interest, not to rush you into an investment.

"One checkpoint at a time."

Based in Orange County, California — serving clients across the United States via video conference and the Checkpoint Planning Client Portal.

FAQ

Questions people ask after an inheritance.

Do I need to decide what to do with the money right away?

Almost never. Aside from a few tax deadlines worth knowing about, most decisions can — and should — wait until you've had time to think clearly.

I inherited a retirement account. What are the rules?

Inherited IRA distribution rules vary based on your relationship to the original owner and when they passed. This is one of the most common questions we help clients work through.

Can you help me decide what to do with an inherited house?

Yes — we help weigh the financial tradeoffs of keeping, renting, or selling inherited property alongside your broader plan.

I feel guilty about the money. Is that normal?

Very common. The Where We Begin session gives you space to think through what the inheritance represents, not just what to do with it financially.

One checkpoint at a time.

Get the free guide, then schedule your complimentary Where We Begin session whenever you're ready to talk it through.

[Get My Free Guide](#)

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CHECKPOINT PLANNING

Section 2

Lead Magnets — 4 Guides

Lead Magnets

Four downloadable guides, one per transition, offered as the opt-in incentive on the matching landing page. “Your Next Checkpoint” (job loss) is the firm’s existing, previously produced workbook, included here as-is and reproduced in full on the following pages. The three guides after it (Early Retirement, Divorce, Inheritance) are new and written to match its structure and tone — currently in plain-text form, pending final design to match the existing workbook’s layout.



Financial Clarity for Life's In-Betweens

Your Next Checkpoint Financial Clarity During Career Transition

A simple workbook to organize your next 90 days.



Your Next Checkpoint Financial Clarity During Career Transition



A companion workbook for individuals navigating job loss, career change, or employment transitions.

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Representatives do not provide tax or legal advice. Please consult with your tax advisor or attorney regarding your situation. Trades cannot be communicated to your Representative by e-mail, fax or regular mail as the transaction may not be executed on a timely basis. Please contact your Representative by telephone to request trades and do not use e-mail to send confidential information or time sensitive instructions. Performance quoted does not guarantee future results. Please refer to your regular periodic statement for complete information. The content of your e-mail is not private as it is subject to review. If you are not the intended recipient and have received this e-mail in error, please contact the sender immediately and delete this material from your computer.

Scott Marcoe
Founder & Financial Planner

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Table of Contents

How To Use This Workbook	4
Where You Are Today	5
Support and Stability Map	6
Income Snapshot	7
Essential Spending Snapshot	8
Runway Estimate	9
Adjustable Spending Review	10
Debt Snapshot & Priority Map	11
First 30 Days Checkpoint	12
Next 30 Days Checkpoint	13
Final 30 Days Checkpoint	14
Decisions I Do Not Need To Make Yet	15
Questions To Bring To a Professional	16
My 30, 60, and 90 Day Plan	17
Notes and Reflections	18
Resources	19

How To Use This Workbook

This workbook is designed to support you during a period of transition. It is a companion to The Checkpoint Strategy™ workshop and offers a simple way to organize your thoughts, understand your financial picture, and identify a few meaningful next steps.

How to use it:

Start with the sections that feel most helpful. There is no right or wrong order. You can work through one page, a few pages, or all of it depending on what you need right now.

What this workbook is:

- A tool to help you gain clarity
- A place to capture ideas and questions
- A simple structure for your next 90 days

What this workbook is not:

- A full financial plan
- Tax or legal advice
- Something you need to complete cover to cover

Where You Are Today

Transitions affect both finances and emotions. Before we map your next steps, take a moment to acknowledge where you are starting.

Three words that describe how I feel about money right now:

What worries me most in the next 30 days:

What I most want to protect during this transition:

There is no need to solve these concerns today. Naming them is the first step toward clarity.

Support and Stability Map

Even during uncertainty, you are not starting from zero. This page helps you identify the people and resources already available to you.

People I can reach out to for support:

Resources I already have:

Examples include savings, severance, benefits, skills, networks, or community support.

Clarity begins with recognizing what is already in place.

Income Snapshot

Understanding your sources of income is a key part of your 30 day checkpoint. List any income that may apply to your situation.

INCOME WORKSHEET

Income Source:

Current Monthly

Projected Monthly

Your salary, wages, tips

Your spouse's salary, wages, tips

Other Income:

Unemployment Compensation

Severance Compensation

Savings (used for living expenses)

Part-Time Work

Consulting

Support from Family

Other

Total Monthly Income

Use this number as a starting point. It does not need to be perfect.

Essential Spending Snapshot

During transition, clarity about essential spending creates stability. List your non negotiable expenses.

ESSENTIAL EXPENSE WORKSHEET

	Monthly	Annual
Housing		
Utilities		
Groceries		
Household Items		
Transportation		
Medical		
Insurance		
Minimum Debt Payments		
Phone & Internet		
Other Required Expenses		
	Monthly	Annual
Total Essential Expenses		

This number helps you understand your spending floor during transition.

Runway Estimate

Your financial runway is the length of time your current resources can support your essential needs.

A simple way to think about it is:

Runway equals

Total Resources For Living Expenses

Example
\$100,000

divided by

÷

÷

Total Essential Monthly Expenses

\$5,000

=

Approximate Financial Runway

=

20 Months

How this number makes me feel:

One action I can take this week to extend my runway:

Examples: review one expense category, confirm unemployment eligibility, delay a non essential purchase.

You do not need to build a full plan today. This is about understanding the road ahead.

Adjustable Spending Review

Identify expenses you may be able to adjust temporarily during your job search.

<u>CATEGORY</u>	<u>KEEP</u>	<u>REDUCE</u>	<u>PAUSE</u>
Streaming Services	☐	☐	☐
Dining Out	☐	☐	☐
Memberships	☐	☐	☐
Subscriptions	☐	☐	☐
Entertainment	☐	☐	☐
Clothing/Shopping	☐	☐	☐
Travel/Vacations	☐	☐	☐
Gifts	☐	☐	☐
Other	☐	☐	☐

Notes or ideas:

Debt Snapshot and Priority Map

This worksheet helps you identify your debt priorities during transition.

DEBT SUMMARY

<u>Creditor or loan type</u>	<u>Minimum payment</u>	<u>Interest rate</u>	<u>Balance</u>

Debt Priority Map:

High Priority:
(must stay current)

Medium Priority:
(contact lender if needed)

Low Priority:
(non essential or can be paused)

Notes or ideas:

First 30 Days Checkpoint

The first 30 days of a transition are about stability.

Stabilize income and benefits:

- **Confirm severance details**
- **Review unemployment eligibility**
- **Understand benefits deadlines and coverage dates**
- **Identify essential expenses**

Avoid urgent decisions:

- **Delay major financial commitments**
- **Focus on clarity, not optimization**

My first 30 day priorities:

*You do not need to build a full plan today.
This is about understanding the road ahead.*

Next 30 Days Checkpoint

Once the first month settles, you can clarify cash flow and reset your financial priorities.

My next 30 day goals:

Identify three expenses I can adjust without affecting well being

One professional I want to speak with (coach, tax professional, planner)

One habit that would help me feel more grounded

The goal is to move forward gradually and confidently.

Final 30 Days Checkpoint

By this point, you can begin rebuilding structure for the next chapter.

What stability looks like for me 90 days from now:

Two habits or routines that support that stability:

A financial task I want to complete in this window:

This section is about progress, not perfection.

Decisions I Do Not Need To Make Yet

Not every decision must happen now. Deferring certain decisions is a valid way to reduce stress.

Decisions I can delay:

Earliest date these decisions need to be reviewed:

Permission to pause is part of a healthy transition.

Questions To Bring To a Professional

As you move through this workbook, you may uncover questions for your support team.

Questions for a career coach:

Questions for a tax professional:

Questions for a financial planner:

If a clarity conversation would be helpful, you can request one at any time.

My 30, 60, and 90 Day Plan

Use this page to bring everything together.

My 30 day plan:

One financial task:

One self care action:

One connection to make:

My 60 day plan:

One financial task:

A habit I want to reinforce:

I want to reconnect with:

My 90 day plan:

Two goals that will help me feel more stable:

Notes and Reflections

Use this space for anything that comes to mind during or after the workshop.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Resources

Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB)

Financial tools, budgeting guides, credit education, and consumer rights information.
www.consumerfinance.gov

IRS Unemployment and Tax Guidance

Official information on unemployment benefits, taxes, withholding, and reporting.
www.irs.gov/taxtopics/tc418
www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1099-g

State Unemployment and Workforce Development Offices

Each state provides unemployment benefits, job search assistance, and retraining programs. You can find your state's office at:
www.careeronestop.org/LocalHelp/service-locator.aspx

Benefits.gov

Helps individuals understand federal and state benefit programs, including unemployment, food assistance, and health programs.
www.benefits.gov

USA.gov Employment Services

General government resources for employment, job search, training, and financial assistance during transitions.
www.usa.gov/find-a-job

HealthCare.gov

Official federal marketplace for health insurance enrollment, subsidy information, and coverage options for individuals who have lost employer coverage.
www.healthcare.gov

COBRA Continuation Coverage (U.S. Department of Labor)

Information about COBRA rights, eligibility, coverage timelines, and how to continue former employer health insurance after job loss.
www.dol.gov/general/topic/health-plans/cobra

Covered California

The official California health insurance marketplace. Offers health coverage options, financial assistance, and enrollment support for individuals and families who have lost employer coverage or need affordable insurance during transition.
www.coveredca.com

Medi-Cal (California Medicaid Program)

Provides free or low cost health coverage for individuals and families who qualify based on income, disability, or other criteria. Medi-Cal enrollment is available year round.
www.dhcs.ca.gov/services/medi-cal

County Social Services Offices (California)

Each county provides support for Medi-Cal applications, CalFresh food assistance, and other public benefits. You can find your county office here:
www.cdss.ca.gov/County-Offices

If You Would Like Additional Support

This workbook is designed to help you gain clarity during times of transition. If you find that you would benefit from a deeper conversation about your financial picture, support is available.

You can schedule a complimentary Clarity Conversation at your convenience.

This is not a financial plan and there is no obligation of any kind.

It is simply a structured, confidential space to review:

- Where you are today
- What has changed
- What decisions matter now
- What can wait
- Your next 30, 60, and 90-day steps

Contact Information:

Scott Marcoe

Founder & Financial Planner, Checkpoint Planning

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www.checkpointplanning.com

All conversations are confidential. You decide if and how you want to continue.



Use the contact information above or scan the QR Code to select your meeting time.

Your Next Checkpoint

The Early Retirement Checkpoint Guide

Financial Clarity for Life's In-Betweens

A simple guide to the decisions that don't wait until 65.

How to Use This Guide

This guide is designed to support you as you consider or move into early retirement. It is a companion to The Checkpoint Strategy™ and offers a simple way to organize your thinking before you make decisions that are difficult to undo.

What this guide is:

- A tool to help you gain clarity on the decisions that are unique to retiring early
- A place to capture questions before a conversation with a planner
- A simple structure for the next 90 days

What this guide is not:

- A full financial plan
 - Tax or legal advice
 - A replacement for a Social Security timing analysis or pension election review specific to your situation
-

Where You Are Today

Retiring earlier than the standard timeline — by choice or otherwise — brings a different kind of transition than a typical retirement.

- What prompted this timeline? (a choice, a layoff, a health consideration, a spouse's plans)
- Three words that describe how I feel about retiring on this timeline:
- What I most want to protect as I make this decision:

There is no need to have this fully resolved today. Naming it is the first step.

The Five Decisions That Don't Wait

1. Healthcare Before Medicare

If you're retiring before 65, you need a coverage plan for the gap. Compare COBRA, ACA marketplace plans, and a spouse's employer coverage — including real monthly costs, not just premiums.

Question to answer: How many years until I'm Medicare-eligible, and what will coverage cost me until then?

2. Social Security Timing

Claiming early (as soon as 62), at full retirement age, or later (up to 70) changes your monthly benefit substantially and permanently. Retiring early doesn't mean you have to claim early.

Question to answer: Have I run the numbers on claiming at 62 vs. full retirement age vs. 70 — not just the monthly amount, but the break-even age?

3. Pension Elections

If a pension is part of your retirement, lump sum vs. annuity and survivor benefit elections are typically permanent once made.

Question to answer: Do I understand the tradeoffs of every election option available to me, and has anyone modeled them side by side?

4. Portfolio Longevity

An early retirement means your savings need to last longer than a standard 30-year retirement horizon. A withdrawal rate that works for someone retiring at 65 may not work for someone retiring at 55.

Question to answer: Has anyone run a retirement readiness projection based on my actual retirement age, not a generic assumption?

5. Required Minimum Distributions (RMDs) and Roth Conversions

The years between early retirement and RMD age are often the best window for Roth conversions, when income — and tax rates — may be lower.

Question to answer: Am I using the low-income years before RMDs begin to my advantage?

Income Snapshot

List every income source that may apply once you retire.

Income Source	Current Monthly	Projected Monthly (Post-Retirement)
Pension		
Social Security (if claiming)		
Part-time work / consulting		
Portfolio withdrawals		
Spouse's income		
Other		
Total Monthly Income		

My First 90 Days Checkpoint

First 30 days — Stabilize

- Confirm health coverage start date and cost

- Understand any pension election deadlines
- Delay any irreversible decisions (Social Security claim, pension election, large withdrawals)

Next 30 days — Clarify

- Run a retirement income projection based on your real numbers
- Identify one professional to talk to (financial planner, tax advisor)

Final 30 days — Decide

- Make Social Security and pension elections with full information
 - Set your withdrawal strategy for year one
-

Decisions I Do Not Need to Make Yet

Not every decision needs to happen before you retire. Write down what can wait, and when you'll revisit it.

- Decisions I can delay:
 - Earliest date these decisions need to be reviewed:
-

Questions to Bring to a Professional

- Questions about Social Security timing:
 - Questions about pension elections:
 - Questions about portfolio withdrawal strategy:
 - Questions about healthcare coverage:
-

If You Would Like Additional Support

This guide is designed to help you gain clarity as you consider early retirement. If you'd benefit from a deeper conversation about your specific numbers, support is available.

Schedule a complimentary Where We Begin session. It is not a financial plan and there is no obligation of any kind — a structured, confidential space to review where you are, what's changed, what decisions matter now, and what can wait.

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insurance and financial services | Ameritas Investment Company, LLC (AIC), Member FINRA/SIPC – securities and investments | Ameritas Advisory Services, LLC (AAS) – investment advisory services. AIC and AAS are not affiliated with Capstone Financial Group.

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Your Next Checkpoint

The Divorce Financial Checkpoint Guide

Financial Clarity for Life's In-Betweens

A simple guide to the financial questions behind the legal ones.

How to Use This Guide

This guide is designed to support you during divorce, separate from — but alongside — the legal process. It offers a simple way to organize the financial side of your situation before you finalize a settlement.

What this guide is:

- A tool to help you understand the financial implications of divorce
- A place to capture questions to bring to your attorney or a financial planner
- A simple structure for evaluating a proposed settlement

What this guide is not:

- Legal advice or a substitute for your divorce attorney
 - Tax advice
 - A guarantee of any particular financial outcome
-

Where You Are Today

Divorce affects finances and emotions together. Before reviewing the numbers, take a moment to acknowledge where you're starting.

- What worries me most about the financial side of this process:
- Three words that describe how I feel about money right now:
- What I most want to protect financially:

There is no need to solve these today. Naming them is the first step toward clarity.

Five Things to Understand Before You Sign

1. The Real Value of a Settlement

A settlement's headline number isn't the same as its after-tax, after-cost value. A dollar in a Roth IRA is not the same as a dollar in a traditional 401(k) or a dollar of home equity.

Question to answer: Have I evaluated the after-tax value of each asset in the proposed settlement, not just the total?

2. QDROs and Retirement Account Division

Dividing a 401(k) or pension typically requires a Qualified Domestic Relations Order (QDRO) — a separate legal document from your divorce decree. IRAs are divided differently, through a transfer incident to divorce.

Question to answer: Do I understand which accounts require a QDRO, and has one been drafted correctly?

3. Tax Filing Status and Support

Your filing status changes, and the tax treatment of spousal support depends on when your agreement was finalized. Child support is generally not deductible or taxable; spousal support rules vary by agreement date.

Question to answer: Do I understand how my tax situation changes in the first year after divorce?

4. A New Household Budget

Rebuilding a cash flow plan for a single household — often on a single income — is one of the most immediate practical needs after divorce.

Question to answer: Have I built a realistic budget based on my post-divorce income and expenses, not my pre-divorce ones?

5. Insurance and Beneficiary Updates

Life insurance, health coverage, and beneficiary designations on retirement accounts are easy to overlook after a divorce is final — and easy to get wrong if left unchanged.

Question to answer: Have I updated every beneficiary designation and insurance policy that still names my former spouse?

Settlement Snapshot

Use this to organize what's on the table before you evaluate it.

Asset / Account	Proposed Allocation	Tax Treatment	Notes
Home / real estate			
401(k) / retirement accounts			
Investment accounts			
Business interests			
Debt			
Spousal / child support			

My First 90 Days Checkpoint

First 30 days — Stabilize

- Open individual bank and credit accounts if you haven't already
- Confirm health insurance coverage going forward

- Delay any major financial commitments until the settlement is finalized

Next 30 days — Clarify

- Build a post-divorce household budget
- Identify one professional to talk to about the settlement (financial planner, tax advisor)

Final 30 days — Rebuild

- Update beneficiary designations and insurance
 - Set a savings and investment plan for your new household
-

Decisions I Do Not Need to Make Yet

Not every financial decision needs to happen immediately. Write down what can wait.

- Decisions I can delay:
 - Earliest date these decisions need to be reviewed:
-

Questions to Bring to a Professional

- Questions for my attorney:
 - Questions for a tax professional:
 - Questions for a financial planner:
-

If You Would Like Additional Support

This guide is designed to help you gain financial clarity during divorce. If you'd benefit from a deeper, confidential conversation about your specific situation, support is available.

Schedule a complimentary Where We Begin session. It is not a financial plan and there is no obligation of any kind — a structured, confidential space to review where you are, what's changed, what decisions matter now, and what can wait.

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Your Next Checkpoint

The Inheritance Checkpoint Guide

Financial Clarity for Life's In-Betweens

A simple guide for the first 90 days after an inheritance.

How to Use This Guide

This guide is designed to support you after receiving an inheritance or unexpected wealth. It offers a simple way to organize your thinking — there is rarely a need to decide anything quickly.

What this guide is:

- A tool to help you gain clarity before making decisions
- A place to capture questions and understand key deadlines
- A simple structure for your next 90 days

What this guide is not:

- A full financial plan
 - Tax or legal advice
 - Something you need to act on immediately
-

Where You Are Today

An inheritance often brings a mix of emotions alongside the financial questions — relief, grief, opportunity, guilt, or all of them at once.

- What I'm feeling right now, beyond the financial questions:
- What I most want to honor or protect with this inheritance:
- What worries me most about making the "wrong" decision:

There is no need to resolve these today. Naming them is the first step toward clarity.

Five Things Worth Understanding First

1. Inherited IRA Rules

Required distribution timelines differ significantly depending on your relationship to the person who passed away, and whether they were already taking required minimum distributions. Getting this wrong can trigger unnecessary taxes or penalties.

Question to answer: Do I know which distribution rules apply to any retirement account I inherited?

2. Step-Up in Cost Basis

Inherited assets like stocks, mutual funds, or real estate typically receive a "step-up" in cost basis to their value on the date of death — which can significantly reduce capital gains tax if you sell.

Question to answer: Do I know the stepped-up basis of what I inherited, and has it been documented?

3. Inherited Real Estate

Keeping, renting, or selling an inherited home is both a financial and emotional decision. Each option has different tax, maintenance, and cash flow implications.

Question to answer: Have I weighed the true costs and benefits of keeping this property against selling it?

4. Investing the Proceeds

An inheritance doesn't need to be invested the way it was previously invested, or the way anyone else tells you to invest it. It deserves an allocation that fits your goals and risk tolerance.

Question to answer: Does my plan for this money reflect my goals, or is it just sitting in whatever account it arrived in?

5. Debt, Goals, and Balance

Paying down debt, funding goals, and investing for the future are not mutually exclusive. Most people benefit from doing some of each, in the right proportion.

Question to answer: Have I thought through the right balance for my situation, rather than doing "all" of one thing?

What I Inherited — Snapshot

Asset	Approximate Value	Tax Treatment (if known)	Any Deadline?
Retirement account (IRA / 401k)			
Brokerage / investment account			
Real estate			
Cash / bank account			
Other			

My First 90 Days Checkpoint

First 30 days — Protect

- Confirm any distribution deadlines on inherited retirement accounts
- Keep inherited funds in place; avoid spending or investing under pressure
- Identify what, if anything, has a real deadline (most things do not)

Next 30 days — Understand

- Document the cost basis of inherited assets
- Identify one professional to talk to (financial planner, tax advisor, estate attorney if needed)

Final 30 days — Decide, Thoughtfully

- Build an investment or spending plan aligned with your goals
 - Make a plan for any inherited property
-

Decisions I Do Not Need to Make Yet

Almost nothing about an inheritance needs to be decided immediately. Write down what can wait.

- Decisions I can delay:
 - Earliest date these decisions need to be reviewed:
-

Questions to Bring to a Professional

- Questions about inherited retirement account rules:
 - Questions about taxes on what I inherited:
 - Questions about investing or using the money:
-

If You Would Like Additional Support

This guide is designed to help you gain clarity after an inheritance, at your own pace. If you'd benefit from a deeper conversation, support is available.

Schedule a complimentary Where We Begin session. It is not a financial plan and there is no obligation of any kind — a structured, confidential space to review where you are, what's changed, what decisions matter now, and what can wait.

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CHECKPOINT PLANNING

Section 3

Compliance Notes

Compliance Notes

A quick-reference summary of the disclosures and compliance-relevant elements built into this material, for reviewer convenience. This is not a substitute for full review — it is a map of where things live.

Business-name & broker-dealer disclosure

Present in the footer of all 10 website pages and all 4 new lead magnets: “Scott Marcoe offers products and services using the following business names: Checkpoint Planning — Capstone Financial Group, insurance and financial services | Ameritas Investment Company, LLC (AIC), Member FINRA/SIPC, securities and investments | Ameritas Advisory Services, LLC (AAS), investment advisory services. AIC and AAS are not affiliated with Capstone Financial Group.”

Form CRS links

Added to the main navigation (a “Form CRS” menu) and the footer of every website page, linking directly to the AIC Form CRS (ameritas.com/OCM/GetFile?doc=567904) and AAS Form CRS (ameritas.com/OCM/GetFile?doc=567905).

“Not investment advice” / educational-purposes language

Present in the footer of all website pages and at the close of all 4 lead magnets.

Fiduciary standard language

Stated plainly on the Home and Our Process pages (“We are legally required to act in your best interest at all times—not the firm's interest, not a product manufacturer's, and not our own”) and echoed on each transition landing page.

Fee transparency

Full flat-fee planning packages (\$1,200 / \$2,400 / \$4,800) and the tiered AUM fee schedule (0.65%–1.25%) are published in full on the Fees page, matching the firm's existing Fees & Services document.

No performance claims or guarantees

No specific investment returns, performance figures, or outcome guarantees appear anywhere in the new material. All language is process- and service-oriented (the Checkpoint Strategy™ framework, session structure, and what's included at each fee tier).

Testimonials

None are used anywhere in this material.

Lead capture / data handling

Each form states “Your information is confidential and never sold. No obligation.” Submitted leads are stored in a private Google Sheet accessible only to Scott Marcoe.

CRPC™ and licensing credentials

CRPC™ (College for Financial Planning), FINRA/SIPC registration through Ameritas Investment Company, LLC, and Life & Health license #0E59309 are listed on the About page alongside the CRPC badge graphic.

Reviewer Sign-Off

Reviewed by: _____ Date: _____

☐ Approved as submitted ☐ Approved with changes (noted below) ☐ Not approved

Notes: